2017 ordered 'a ban on all blasphemous material online', while the interior minister termed all 'blasphemers as enemies of humanity' (HRW 2017). The state already had power to block what it termed 'blasphemous' material online as evident in the ban of YouTube in 2012 after the 'anti-Islam film "Innocence of Muslims", was uploaded to the site sparking violent protests' (Wilkes 2016). But the weaponization of the blasphemy laws has resulted in further abuse, sanctioning what is akin to a witch hunt to find blasphemers online, or enabling further abuse of the blasphemy laws to settle other disputes.

The dangerous intersection between blasphemy laws and social media surveillance was evident in the April 2017 murder of Mashal Khan that highlights the danger associated with such accusations and social media. The accusation that sparked the violent lynching by his fellow students was linked to his activities on Facebook (Akbar 2017). On further investigation it was discovered that the student had been targeted because of his activism against corruption in his university, his murder instigated by university officials (Rasmussen and Baloch 2017). In another case in the same month 'police intervened to prevent a mob from killing a Hindu man accused of sharing blasphemous content on social media in Hub, Balochistan province' (HRW 2017). Blasphemy laws implicate both Muslim and non-Muslim citizens where the accusation may stem from personal vendettas or disputes. This misuse of the blasphemy laws has been further exacerbated through technology. Another example is the case of a Christian man known as 'Nadeem or Nasim James' who went into hiding after his 'Muslim friend' accused him of blasphemy when he shared a poem that was perceived to be insulting of Islam through the instant messaging service WhatsApp, despite the fact the accused in question was said to be illiterate and had no knowledge of using the app, according to his brother (Constable 2016). With the case of Taimoor Raza as the first Pakistani to be sentenced to death for committing blasphemy online, the existing problem of abuse of blasphemy laws against innocent individuals will only be exacerbated. Furthermore, the issue of freedom of speech will continue to be compromised, where any criticism of even the blasphemy laws themselves has resulted in accusations of blasphemy and death (The Economist 2017; Amnesty International 2016). The normalization of such surveillance of online content is further evident in Figure 5.1, which shows a text message sent by the PTA to all customers of mobile networks (this message was received by the co-author). Advising citizens to report blasphemous 'content', in a Pakistani context where such laws have been abused in the past, where, as admitted by an FIA official (Wasim and Tahir 2017) the state does not have the appropriate